

LEGAL LITERACY — BLOCK 1

Topic: Understanding Our Rights

Total Duration: 1 Hour

SESSION PLAN

1. Introduction & Warm-Up — 10 Minutes

Greet the pupils and introduce the topic of the day's class: **their rights**.

Read aloud five or six commonplace scenarios, such as:

- A child being denied education
- Bullying
- Discrimination
- Unequal treatment

Ask pupils to raise their hands or stand up to indicate whether they believe each scenario is **fair or unfair**.

Invite a few pupils to explain their responses. Write important terms from their answers on the board.

Conclude by explaining that **laws are about more than punishment; they also exist to protect people's rights and ensure that people are treated fairly**.

2. Understanding Law, Rights & Dignity — 10 Minutes

Using simple, age-appropriate language, explain the concepts of **law, rights and dignity**.

Law

A set of rules and regulations that helps protect people, maintain order and promote social justice.

Rights

The fundamental freedoms and protections that every person is entitled to in order to live with safety, justice and dignity.

Dignity

Being treated with kindness, respect and worth, regardless of who you are.

Introduce five fundamental rights:

Right to Education

A child from a low-income household should still be able to attend school and pursue their education despite financial difficulties.

Right to Equality

Every student should have an equal opportunity to participate in school elections, regardless of whether they are a boy or a girl.

Right to Dignity

Instead of humiliating a student in front of the class, a teacher discusses their low grades with them privately and respectfully.

Right to Safety

A school promptly investigates and addresses bullying to help ensure that the affected student feels safe.

Right to Help

When a student reports harassment to a trusted teacher, the teacher informs the appropriate adults and takes steps to help keep the student safe.

Ask brief questions throughout the discussion, such as:

- **Why is education important?**
- **How can we show dignity to others?**
- **Why should everyone be treated equally?**

Connect students' answers to the purpose of laws and rights.

3. Rights Scenario Activity — 20 Minutes

Divide students into small groups.

Provide each group with:

- Scenario cards
- Five labelled chart papers:
 - **Education**
 - **Equality**
 - **Dignity**
 - **Safety**
 - **Help**

Ask each group to:

1. Read each scenario.
2. Discuss which right the scenario relates to.
3. Place the scenario card on the appropriate chart.
4. Be prepared to explain their reasoning.

Move around the classroom during the activity to provide guidance and help groups that need assistance.

After the activity, ask each group to present one scenario and explain why they placed it under that particular right.

Clarify misunderstandings and reinforce the key lessons from the activity.

4. Identity Card Activity — 10 Minutes

Ask students to complete an **Identity Card Worksheet** containing:

- Full Name
- Age
- School Name
- Emergency Contact Information
- One Trusted Adult

After completing the worksheet, discuss why knowing this information can be important during an emergency.

Explain the difference between **knowing personal information** and **sharing personal information appropriately**.

Emphasise that private information should only be shared with **trusted adults or appropriate authorities when necessary**.

5. Recap & Exit Questions — 10 Minutes

Summarise the five rights discussed during the lesson:

Education · Equality · Dignity · Safety · Help

Ask each student to answer one short exit question, such as:

- **Name one right you learned today.**
- **Who can you approach if you feel unsafe?**
- **Why is dignity important?**

Conclude by reinforcing the key message:

Every child has rights. Understanding those rights helps us stay safe, ask for help when necessary and respect the rights of others.

MATERIALS REQUIRED

- Whiteboard and markers
- Scenario cards
- Five chart papers labelled:
 - Education
 - Equality
 - Dignity
 - Safety
 - Help
- Sticky notes or tape
- Identity Card worksheet
- Pens/Pencils

LEARNING OUTCOMES

By the end of the session, students will be able to:

- Explain the purpose of law in everyday life.

- Identify five basic rights of every child.
- Recognise situations where rights are protected or violated.
- State important personal identity information.
- Identify trusted adults and appropriate sources of help in unsafe situations.